

# Direct Response to Arbitrum Grant Evaluator Feedback

**Posted:** January 14, 2026

**Application:** DecaFlow Privacy Infrastructure

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**Thank you for the detailed feedback. Here are direct answers to your questions:**

## INNOVATION

**Q: How does your privacy tool actually work? What mechanisms provide privacy?**

DecaFlow uses CoW Protocol's batch auction system as the privacy layer. Here's the actual technical flow:

1. **User signs off-chain intent** expressing their desired trade (e.g., swap 100K USDC → ETH)
2. **Intent goes to CoW Protocol's solver network** (not public mempool) - this is the privacy mechanism
3. **Solvers compete to find best execution** by batching multiple user intents together
4. **Only the final settlement transaction** hits the blockchain - by then, it's too late for MEV bots to front-run
5. **User gets MEV-protected execution** because their trade never appeared in the public mempool

The privacy comes from "dark orderflow" - transactions are hidden from public view until after they're matched and settled.

**Q: How is transaction routing chosen?**

We built an AI model that analyzes each trade and decides: "Is the MEV risk high enough to justify routing through CoW Protocol (slower but protected) vs. direct execution (faster but exposed)?"

The routing logic: - High risk (score  $\geq 7.0$ ): Route through CoW Protocol privacy - Medium risk + large trade (score  $\geq 4.0$  and  $> \$10K$ ): Privacy route - Low risk: Direct route (faster)

Risk score is calculated using 20+ features: swap size vs liquidity, gas price, time of day, mempool congestion, historical MEV patterns for that token pair, etc.

We haven't trained the full ML model yet - that's what the grant funds. Right now we use a simpler rule-based system.

**Q: Provide onchain traction data**

Honest current numbers: - **Users:** ~100 (intentional soft launch) - **Total swaps:** ~500 - **Privacy swaps via CoW:** ~150 - **Volume:** ~\$150K total

We know these numbers are small. Here's why:

We launched on mainnet Dec 20, 2025 but intentionally did NOT market because: 1. SDK isn't ready (building with grant funds) 2. AI model isn't trained (building with

grant funds)

3. Protocol integrations aren't complete (building with grant funds)

We wanted to validate the tech works before driving traffic. The grant transforms us from "DEX with 100 users" to "infrastructure powering GMX, Camelot, etc. with 10,000+ users."

All swaps are verifiable on-chain. We can provide contract addresses if helpful.

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## TEAM

**Q: What crypto startups/projects have you worked on? What roles?**

**Utibe Samuel (Founder): - CreedTech Group (2019-2021):** Co-founder & PM of blockchain dev agency. Managed distributed team of 5-10 smart contract devs. Oversaw Solidity audits and deployments for DeFi protocols, NFT projects, and DAO governance systems for client projects. - **Blockroll (2021-2022):** Project Manager for Web3 ecosystem. Led partnership campaigns that grew ecosystem by 25%. Coordinated with DAOs and early-stage crypto projects. - **Affidex Lab (2022-2024):** Business Developer for blockchain + AI incubator. Drove BD for multiple portfolio companies in the Web3 space. - **DecaFlow (2024-present):** Founded after seeing the MEV problem firsthand while trading on L2s.

**Edidiong Samuel (CTO): - TransactX (2020-2022):** Technical lead for fintech API. Not crypto but demonstrates ability to build production systems (50K+ users, 99.9% uptime, 15K daily transactions). - **VestPad (2021-2022):** Smart contract developer. Built Solidity-based DeFi launchpad deployed on Ethereum and BSC. Used The Graph for indexing. - **Swap2Naira (2022):** Backend developer for DEX. Laravel + React stack. - **DecaFlow (2024-present):** Built entire protocol stack - smart contracts, CoW Protocol integration, cross-chain bridges, frontend, backend.

**Q: GitHub links**

- **CTO GitHub:** <https://github.com/dakeem05> (76 public repos, demonstrates Solidity/TypeScript expertise)
- **Project GitHub:** <https://github.com/affidexlab/new> (500+ commits, fully public, live protocol code)

You can verify: - Smart contracts deployed on Arbitrum - CoW Protocol integration is functional - Multi-chain bridges work (CCIP, CCIP, Socket) - Production backend and frontend

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## MILESTONES & KPIs

**Q: Remove retroactive work**

Agreed. We've restructured milestones to fund ONLY future work:

NOT FUNDED (already done): - Core swap protocol - Privacy routing via CoW - Smart contracts deployed - Basic frontend/backend

GRANT FUNDS (not yet built): - Privacy SDK (Solidity, TypeScript, Python libraries) - 0% done - AI MEV prediction engine - data collection started, model not trained - Protocol integrations (GMX, Camelot) - discussions started, not integrated - MEV analytics dashboard - design sketched, not implemented - Timeboost research - not started - Security audit - not started

**Q: Clarify relevance to Arbitrum**

You're right to call this out. We'll remove: - Generic dashboard improvements - Multichain LLM features - Features unrelated to Arbitrum

We'll focus ONLY on: - SDK for Arbitrum protocols (GMX, Camelot, Radiant) - AI trained on Arbitrum transaction data - Timeboost research (Arbitrum-exclusive) - MEV dashboard for Arbitrum ecosystem - Arbitrum-first integrations

### **Q: Actionable KPIs tied to traction/adoption**

New KPIs (measurable, verifiable on-chain):

**Milestone 1 (SDK & AI):** - AI model accuracy: >85% on Arbitrum validation set - SDK downloads: 50+ (NPM + PyPI) - Gas efficiency: <150K per privacy swap

**Milestone 2 (Integrations):** - Live protocol integrations: 3+ on Arbitrum mainnet - Privacy transactions: 500+ verifiable on-chain - Volume through privacy routes: \$5M+ - MEV saved: \$100K+ (measurable via price impact analysis)

**Milestone 3 (Dashboard):** - Dashboard monthly users: 1,000+ - Arbitrum swaps indexed: 1M+ - Report readership: 5,000+

**Milestone 4 (Security & Research):** - Security audit: 0 critical findings - Timeboost research: 500+ paper views - Bug bounty: Program live with \$50K pool

**Cumulative (Month 6):** - Total Arbitrum users: 10,000+ - MEV saved on Arbitrum: \$1M+ (20x ROI on grant) - Protocol integrations: 5+ Arbitrum protocols - Volume: \$25M+ on Arbitrum

All metrics are on-chain verifiable or publicly auditable.

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## **ALIGNMENT**

### **Q: Base vs Arbitrum focus - why does your whitepaper say Base is native chain?**

You caught a genuine mistake on our part. Here's what happened:

**December 2025:** We initially designed DecaFlow with Base as the primary chain (hence the whitepaper wording). We deployed there first because of Coinbase's marketing push.

**January 2026:** After deploying multi-chain (Base, Arbitrum, Optimism, Polygon), we realized **Arbitrum is the better fit** for several reasons: 1. Larger DeFi ecosystem (GMX, Camelot, Radiant vs Base's smaller protocols) 2. Timeboost technology (unique to Arbitrum, perfect for our privacy thesis) 3. More MEV activity = bigger problem to solve = more value to add 4. Better alignment with our mission

**The pivot:** We're now Arbitrum-first. This grant application represents our commitment to make Arbitrum the primary focus.

**How we prove it:** - Grant funds go to Arbitrum-only work (GMX, Camelot, Timeboost, Arbitrum MEV dashboard) - First integrations will be Arbitrum protocols (before expanding to Base) - AI model trained primarily on Arbitrum transaction data - All KPIs measured on Arbitrum

**Why multichain helps Arbitrum:** - Network effects: More data (even from other chains) improves the AI model, which Arbitrum users benefit from - User acquisition: Base users discover privacy on Base → migrate to Arbitrum for better DeFi ecosystem - Revenue: Fees from other chains fund continued Arbitrum development

But to be crystal clear: **This grant funds Arbitrum-exclusive work. Not one**

**dollar goes to Base features.**

**Q: How does project align with Timeboost program?**

Timeboost is CENTRAL to our thesis. Here's why:

**Problem:** CoW Protocol privacy is slow (12-60 seconds). For critical trades, that might not be fast enough.

**Opportunity:** What if we combine Timeboost + CoW Protocol? Can we get "fast privacy" by bidding for priority in the express lane while still using batch auctions?

**Research questions (grant-funded):** 1. Can Timeboost accelerate CoW Protocol settlement? 2. What's the cost/benefit? (Spend \$50 on Timeboost to save \$500 in MEV = worth it) 3. When should AI recommend "Timeboost + privacy" vs "privacy only" vs "direct"?

**Deliverable:** 20+ page research paper analyzing three strategies, prototype implementation on testnet, cost-benefit analysis, published to Arbitrum Forum.

**Why this matters:** We'd be the first production protocol to integrate Timeboost with privacy routing. This showcases Arbitrum's unique tech and creates a blueprint for other protocols.

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## Summary

We appreciate the tough feedback. You're right that our first submission lacked: - Technical depth on privacy mechanisms (now explained) - Concrete traction data (now provided with context) - Team crypto credentials (now detailed) - Clear Arbitrum alignment (now clarified)

We're happy to answer follow-up questions or provide additional verification (contract addresses, commit history, etc.).

**Core ask:** \$50K over 6 months to build privacy infrastructure (SDK, AI, integrations) that positions Arbitrum as the most MEV-resistant L2.

**Measurable outcome:** \$1M+ MEV saved for Arbitrum users = 20x ROI on grant.

We're a proven team (live protocol on mainnet) asking for growth capital to scale, not speculative funding for an idea.

Thank you for considering our resubmission.

— Utibe & Edidiong, DecaFlow Team